

Qwen

ALIBABA

LONG CONTEXT

“Bilingual, budget-friendly, and built for the highest-volume workloads — a trillion-parameter model priced like a mid-tier one.”

BEST FOR

- Bilingual (Chinese/English) and multilingual business tasks
- 1M+ token context windows across the whole model family
- Budget-sensitive, high-volume deployments
- Multimodal input: text, image, and video in one prompt (Qwen3.8-Max)
- Coding and agentic workflows at competitive pricing

NOT BEST FOR

- ✗ The newest flagship (Qwen3.8-Max) is still rolling out to all regions
- ✗ Documentation and support skew toward developers, not businesses
- ✗ Confirm data handling and compliance for regulated industries

GETTING STARTED

- Go to [qwen.ai](#) (or the Alibaba Cloud app) and sign up free.
- Test the free chat tier on a real business task.
- For API access, create an Alibaba Cloud Model Studio account.
- Choose your tier: Plus for cost, Max for top capability.

PRICING

PLAN	PRICE	NOTES
Free chat	\$0/mo	qwen.ai web/app, rate-limited
Qwen3.7 Plus (API)	\$0.40 / \$1.60 per 1M tok	Best cost-to-capability ratio
Qwen3.8-Max (API)	\$2.00 / \$6.00 per 1M tok	Top-tier reasoning and multimodal
Alibaba Cloud Enterprise	Custom	SLAs, dedicated capacity, compliance support

KEY FEATURES

- Qwen3.8-Max: 2.4T total / 95B active parameters, 1M context, multimodal (Aug 2026)
- Qwen3.7 Plus: same 1M context at roughly 6x lower cost than Max
- Strong bilingual reasoning and translation quality
- Open-weight variants available for self-hosting alongside the closed flagship
- Fast release cadence — new checkpoints roughly every 4-6 weeks

PROMPT TEMPLATES

“Translate this client email to Mandarin, keep the tone professional but warm: [paste email]”

“Read this 200-page vendor contract and list every clause that mentions liability: [paste/upload]”

“Write product descriptions in English and Chinese for this item: [paste details]”

“Given this dataset, identify the 3 biggest cost-saving opportunities: [paste data]”

QUICK REFERENCE

Start fresh	New chat on qwen.ai
Work bilingually	Just switch languages mid-conversation
Process a huge file	Upload directly — 1M-token context
Keep costs down	Use Qwen3.7 Plus instead of Max
Build a product	Use the Model Studio API

PRO TIPS

- Default to the Plus tier unless a task specifically needs Max-level reasoning — the cost gap is roughly 5x.
- Qwen's bilingual quality makes it a strong pick for any business with Chinese-speaking clients or vendors.
- Batch high-volume, repetitive API calls together to make the most of the low per-token pricing.
- Watch for new checkpoints — this family updates faster than most competitors.